4. Empowering women in all aspects.
5. Inclusion of all groups with special attention to the SCs, STs, OBCs and minorities.
6. Equality of opportunity for the youth.
7. Transparency through the use of technology to make government visible and responsive.

Through its commitment to a cooperative federalism, promotion of citizen engagement, egalitarian access to opportunity, participative and adaptive governance and increasing use of technology, the NITI Aayog seeks to provide a critical directional and strategic input into the development process. This, along with being the incubator of ideas for development, is the core mission of NITI Aayog.[8]

Cooperative Federalism[8]

The NITI Aayog has been constituted to actualise the important goal of cooperative federalism and to enable good governance in India. On the premise that strong states make a strong nation, NITI Aayog acts as the quintessential platform for the Government of India by bringing States together as 'Team India' to work towards the national development agenda.

In view of this, a number of steps have been taken by NITI Aayog to foster cooperative federalism through structured support initiatives and engagement with the States/UTs on a continuous basis. These include:

1. Meetings between the Prime Minister/Cabinet Ministers and all Chief Ministers;
2. Subgroups of Chief Ministers on subjects of national importance;
3. Sharing of best practices;
4. Policy support and capacity development of State/UT functionaries;
5. Launching of the Aspirational Districts Programme for development of backward districts;
6. Theme-based extensive engagements in various sectors;
7. Framing model laws for land leasing and agriculture marketing reforms; and
8. Area-specific interventions for the North-Eastern and Himalayan States and island development.

The NITI Aayog has been providing relevant technical advice to the Centre, States and UTs. It has also established models and programmes for the development of infrastructure and to reignite and establish private-public partnership, such as the Centre-state partnership model Development Support Services to States and Union Territories (DSSS); and the Sustainable Action for Transforming Human Capital (SATH) programme.[9]

Competitive Federalism[9]

The NITI Aayog endeavours to promote competitive federalism by facilitating improved performance of States/UTs. It encourages healthy competition among states through transparent rankings, in various sectors, along with a hand-holding approach. Some of the indices launched by NITI Aayog are School Education Quality Index, State Health Index, Composite Water Management Index, Sustainable